

CDN Incident Alert: 0077. TLP: CLEAR				Date
Title	EU	Flagged and Ignored: Testing X's Response to EU Sanction Violations		24/07/2025
Summary				
- 125 tweets containing content produced by sanctioned entities were flagged to X via their DSA Article 16 flagging system, resulting in 71 declinations, 53 did not receive any acknowledgement of the report, and 1 takedown. X's inaction potentially constitutes a violation of the DSA obligations under articles 34, 35 and 16. - No narratives were analysed for this report. - The content had 3.5 million views, and the accounts posting them had 10.2 million followers. - The channels' objectives were likely to facilitate Russian influence operation content and smear the West and Ukraine through influence operations posing as news outlets and journalists. - Building closer cooperation around sanctions enforcement across government and civil society is key to addressing this issue.				
Incident				
On July 8th and 9th, Science Feedback and Alliance4Europe reported 125 tweets from sanctioned Russian entities to X, calling on X to enforce EU sanctions. The reporting was done through X's DSA-mandated reporting tool. On July 9th, X declined to act on 71 of the 125 flagged content, did not acknowledge 53 of the reports, and only took down one of the accounts, a Russian Doppelganger operation account. Independent of our flagging, the Doppelganger posts were taken down by the 10th, too late to have any relevant effect, as the operation had already abandoned the account after reaching its targets. 7 of the tweets flagged were declined within 2 minutes. The accounts flagged are sanctioned under Council Regulation (EU) No 833/2014, Article 2f, and Council Regulation (EU) No 269/2014, which prohibits financial resources from being made available to them. In a Q&A by the European Commission DG FISMA, the Commission clarifies that the sanctions also entail hosting the entities and their content on social media platforms. X's failure to geofence the illegal content and accounts might stipulate a violation of DSA Articles 34 and 35, while their failure to send an acknowledgement of the reports might stipulate a violation of DSA Article 16.				
Narrative				
Meta narrative: N/A Sub-narratives: N/A				
Impact				
Reach: Collectively, the channels that published the tweets that were reported had 10.2 million followers. The content reported had 3.5 million views in total. Outcome: EU-sanctioned Russian content is reaching European audiences.				
Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework).				
Objective: T0002: Facilitate State Propaganda – the channels are spreading EU-sanctioned Russian media content Objective: T0135.001: Smear – A majority of the content is trying to undermine either the West or Ukraine. T0097.202: News Outlet Persona – Sanctioned Russian influence operations like RT are posing as authentic media, trying to use the persona to give legitimacy to the content they distribute. T0097.102: Journalist Persona – Employees of sanctioned influence operations are posing as journalists. T0097.206: Government Institution Persona – Russian embassies are using their status to spread sanctioned content. T0129.009: Remove Post Origins – Some of the channels observed are removing the RT watermark from content.				
Recommendations and Actions Taken				
Action taken: Reported to tweets to X; Sent results to European Commission and EU member state authorities. Recommendations: Strengthening EU Resilience: Closer cooperation around sanction enforcement, bringing together European governments across ministries, European institutions, civil society, and the OSINT community; Use national regulations and the DSA to enforce the sanctions.				
Report	Threat	Actor	Evidence	Authors
				Platforms
				Logo

A4E SF	Russia	Upon request	Charles Terroille, Science Feedback, Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe, Ewan Casandjian, Alliance4Europe, Commissioned by WeMove Europe. A4E funded by the Polish MFA .	X
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